

Whoever You Are

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Source: `Whoever you are (Mem Fox).pdf` (36 PDF pages; story on PDF pages 11-33)

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> Internal school working copy prepared from a school-accessible PDF. Keep with the restricted book files. Do not publish this transcript in GitHub, Supabase, or the public progress viewer.

There are little ones just like you
all over the world.

Their skin may be
different from yours,
and their homes may be
different from yours,
and their lands may be
different from yours.

Their lives may be
different from yours,
and their words may be
very different from yours.

But inside,
their hearts are
just like yours,
whoever they are,
wherever they are,
all over the world.

And they laugh just like you.

You may be different,
and they may be different,
wherever you are,
wherever they are,
in this big, wide world.

Pain is the same,
and blood is the same.

Smiles are the same,
and hearts are just the same,
wherever they are,
wherever you are,
wherever we are.

- The opening spreads introduce children -- little ones just like you -- all over the world, in homes, lands and lives that differ from the reader's.

- The middle spreads contrast outward differences (skin, homes, lands, lives, words) with the inward sameness of hearts and laughter.
- The closing spreads gather the theme -- pain, blood, smiles and hearts the same wherever they are, wherever you are, wherever we are -- in this big, wide world.

Story text transcribed from the embedded text layer (PDF pages 11-33), kept line-by-line as printed, with decorative border glyphs excluded. Cover and title matter, the dedication (page 7), copyright and cataloguing data (page 6), digitisation matter (page 8) and the review quotation (page 36) are not included as story prose. Pixel-level visual verification against the rendered scans has not yet been completed -- my image-reading tool is currently unavailable, so please check the transcript against the PDF before treating it as final.